

Consonant sounds

What is Spoken English?

Spoken English is the use of the English language through speech for communication. It focuses on pronunciation, stress, intonation, fluency, and correct use of sounds so that speech is clear and easily understood by listeners.

Consonant Sounds Followed by /KW/

The sound /kw/ is a consonant cluster made up of two sounds produced closely together:

/k/ – a voiceless velar plosive

:w/ – a voiced bilabial glide

When pronounced, the /k/ sound is released immediately into the /w/ sound, almost as one unit. This cluster often appears at the beginning of words, especially those spelled with “qu”.

Example of pronunciation flow:

queen → /kwi:n/

The /k/ sound is followed immediately by the /w/ sound.

Ten (10) Words with Consonant Sound /KW/

Queen

Quick

Quiet

Quite

Quarrel

Quarter

Question

Quilt

Quench

Quarry

(All the words above begin with the consonant cluster /kw/.)

Five Sentences Using Five of the Words

The queen addressed the nation on television.

1. He gave a quick response to the question.
2. The classroom became quiet when the teacher entered.
3. We bought a loaf and cut it into a quarter.
4. The workers get stones from the quarry.

Class Exercises on /KW/

Exercise 1: Identify the Sound

Underline the words that contain the /kw/ sound.

- a. Queen
- b. Cat
- c. Quiet
- d. Boy
- e. Question

Pronunciation Practice

Write the phonetic transcription of the underlined words.

queen

quick

question

Book References

New oxfords English book 1

O'Connor, J. D. Better English Pronunciation